

André Schepers

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Vereniging van Nederlandse Gemeenten

<https://vng.nl/>

14 September 2026, The Netherlands

Dear municipalities of The Netherlands,

I wrote one of you, the municipality of Harlingen, with regard to Tara: She died while, in my opinion, that could have been prevented. Warning after warning from the Onderzoeksraad voor Veiligheid, accident after accident, and yet, she was allowed on that ship, that killed her. She trusted us, society, with her life that we would keep her safe. We failed.

The question now is to what point you are responsible for the safety in situations that happen in your municipality. What duty of care does a mayor have? If you know a situation is unsafe, potentially lethal like the bruine vloot ships, don't you have a duty of care, a moral obligation, as a mayor, but also as a human being, to do everything in your power to prevent people from entering such a situation?

What did you do as an organization after this incident? This terrible accident? Did you discuss ways to prevent this from ever happening again? Did you go over how this could happen while it was very well known that those ships were dangerous? If not, why not? Don't you wish to prevent this from happening again, especially if you look at the fact that this was a known risk? If you discussed this, what was the outcome? How can I check to what extent I can trust the moral systems that municipalities and mayors of this country are? What have you done in your municipalities to prevent unnecessary accidents like these?

If you did not discuss this, are you then saying that it is not your responsibility? Is that known by high schools, for example, that might implicitly trust you that if one is capable of using ships of a bruine vloot for example, that it then must be safe? Because they believe that if it was known to be unsafe, like the bruine vloot clearly was according to the Onderzoeksraad voor Veiligheid, it must have been shut down by the municipality or the ILT. So what is your view of the contract a municipality in The Netherlands has with society? Did policies change after the accident Tara died in?

The question is now: How safe are children in our society if everybody neglects to take their responsibility? Aren't we doomed to freedom, according to Sartre and de Beauvoir, who both are responsible for L'Être et le Néant?

I demand a description of explicit contracts between municipalities and society that both parties explicitly agreed upon regarding responsibilities and duties of care towards each other. You, municipalities of The Netherlands have lost my trust: Eindhoven water cannon incident, Tara, femicide, etc. We go for explicit contracts that you can be held to, and otherwise societal escalations. These escalations, just to be sure you understand how far I go, are up to the level of international institutions. That means the European Court for Human Rights for example. I have just gotten started!

André Schepers

P.S.: This letter can be found online:

https://github.com/andres81/Model_of_the_Psyche/blob/main/websites/dashboard-of-the-netherlands.andreschepers.nl/public/case-files/organization-for-the-protection-of-natural-persons/abuse_of_minors/letter-to-Vereniging-van-Nederlandse-Gemeenten-VNG.md

P.P.S.: As a citizen of this country, The Netherlands, a democracy, I am always morally responsible for what happens: I merely delegate responsibility to moral systems like municipalities, governments, agencies, and institutions. When they fail, I have to take responsibility for that failure and make sure it doesn't happen again at the very least.